Ingredient class, live microbials/probiotics,: HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

Pendergrass K. "Ingredient class, live microbials/probiotics,: HMTc Standard". Heavy Metal Certified, 2026. https://heavymetalcertified.-com/standards/supplements-probiotics. CC BY 4.0.

CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified standard for Ingredient class: live microbials/probiotics (Dietary Supplements (Human)), stated as sold. Every limit is read across from the strictest sovereign infant-and-child-food maximum level for the analyte and applied to all supplements as a voluntary child-protective over-compliance; the laxer adult supplement floor (sovereign supplement MLs, USP <2232>, Prop 65) is disclosed and never selected.

1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 — child-protective over-compliance: strictest sovereign infant-and-child-food ML by lookup, applied to all supplements; adult floor (supplement ML / USP <2232> / Prop 65 MADL) disclosed, never selected

2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

ANALYTE	TIER	HMTC LIMIT	BASIS
Lead (Pb)	Tier 1	10	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Cadmium (Cd)	Tier 1	5	human-grade read-across (European Union)

Total arsenic (tAs)	Tier 2	50	human-grade read-across (India)
Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	Tier 1	10	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Mercury, total (tHg)	Tier 1	4	human-grade read-across (Israel)
Methylmercury (MeHg)	Tier 1	≤ tHg	bounded by tHg (reflex speciation)
Nickel (Ni)	Tier 2	100	human-grade read-across (European Union)
Tin (Sn)	Tier 2	5,000	human-grade read-across (India)
Aluminium (Al)	Tier 2	500	human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand)
Total chromium (Cr)	Tier 2	1,000	human-grade read-across (China)
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	Tier 2	≤ Cr	bounded by Cr (reflex speciation)

3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

ANALYTE	HMTC	SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION
Lead (Pb)	10	Australia / New Zealand — infant formula products
Cadmium (Cd)	5	European Union — infant formulae, follow-on formulae, food for special medical purposes intended for infants and young children, and young-child formulae placed on the market as liquid and manufactured from cow's milk proteins or cow's milk protein hydrolysates
Total arsenic (tAs)	50	India — Infant Milk substitute and Infant foods

Inorganic arsenic (iAs)	10	European Union — infant formulae, follow-on formulae, food for special medical purposes intended for infants and young children, and young-child formulae placed on the market as liquid
Mercury, total (tHg)	4	Israel — Infant and toddler formulas, ready-to-eat
Methylmercury (MeHg)	≤ tHg	MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.
Nickel (Ni)	100	European Union — infant/young-child formula, liquid
Tin (Sn)	5,000	India — Infant Milk substitute and Infant foods
Aluminium (Al)	500	Australia / New Zealand — infant formula, follow-on formula, and special medical purpose product for infants other than preterm-infant products
Total chromium (Cr)	1,000	China — human-food analog
Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI)	≤ Cr	Cr-VI carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total Cr (Cr-VI <= Cr), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell.

4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. "Ingredient class, live microbials/probiotics,." In Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) Dietary Supplements (Human) standard, version 1.0 (2026-08-14). Institute of Contaminant Standards (ICS), 2026.

References

[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Pb, Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cd, iAs, Ni. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] Israel — human-food maximum levels
Binds tHg. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[5] India — human-food maximum levels
Binds tAs, Sn. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

STATUS AND LICENCE

Editorially reviewed in-house; no external peer review has been completed on this reference. Published as a preprint with its review state tracked on the article page. Released under CC BY 4.0.

COMPETING INTERESTS

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DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/supplements--probiotics. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/supplements--probiotics.